Z. JESSIE LIU

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EDUCATION

University of Pennsylvania 2014 - 2020
Ph.D. in Economics

Fudan University 2009 - 2013
B.A. in Mathematical Economics

ACADEMIC POSITION

Johns Hopkins Carey Business School 2020 - present
Assistant Professor

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Information and Media Economics, Digital Marketing, Empirical Industrial Organization

PUBLICATIONS

How Allowing a Little Bit of Dissent Helps Control Social Media: Impact of Market Structure on Censorship Compliance 2025

- Journal of the European Economic Association, 23(6)
- Media Coverage: ProMarket, The Print, Faculti (interview)

Asymmetric Impact of AI Matching on Influencer Marketing: Implications for Platform Revenue
with Yi Liu 2025

- Marketing Science 44(1), pp.65-83.

Less Is More: A Theory of Minimalist Luxury
with Pinar Yildirim and Z. John Zhang 2024

- Journal of Economics & Management Strategy, 33(1), pp.78-110.
- Media Coverage: World Trademark Review, Knowledge@Wharton, QRIUS

A Theory of Maximalist Luxury
with Pinar Yildirim and Z. John Zhang 2022

- Journal of Economics & Management Strategy, 31(2), pp.284-323.

WORKING PAPERS

Spiral of Silence: How Neutral Moderation Polarizes Content Creation
with Ying Bao

· Minor revision at Management Science

People Are More Likely to Believe and Share Fake News on Smartphones (vs. PCs)
with Minzhe Xu and Yang Yang

· Major revision at Journal of Consumer Research

Reactive Marketing and the Co-production of (In)Authenticity
with Preyas S. Desai

· Major revision at Management Science

When Artificial Differentiation Meets Artificial Intelligence
with Preyas S. Desai

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

Disputing disputes
with Ying Bao, Zimin Pang, and Bobby Zhou

Agency Bias
with Xiaolin Li and Yuanchen Su

The Social Production of Online Toxicity: The Case of Reddit
with Ying Bao and Cameron Martel

Algospeak
with Ying Bao

TikTok Ban on Consumer Perception
with Maiting Zhuang

How Lockdown Policies Impact Online Consumer Reviews
with Haiyang Yang

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

Beyond Takedowns: How Moderation Shapes What Gets Created 2025
with Ying Bao

· EconPol Forum, Vol. 26, No. 4, pp. 47-51. Munich: CESifo GmbH.

INVITED PRESENTATIONS

Conferences

"When Artificial Differentiation Meets Artificial Intelligence"

- Summer Institute in Competitive Strategy (SICS) Conference, Berkeley, CA 2026

"Polarizing Creation through Moderating Toxicity"

- Frank M. Bass UTD FORMS Conference, Dallas, TX 2026
- ISMS Marketing Science Conference, Washington, DC 2025
- International Industrial Organization Conference, Philadelphia, PA 2025
- CESifo workshop on Digital Platforms: Policy and Politics, Italy 2025
- Marketing Theory Seminar, Virtual 2025

"Impact of Market Structure on Censorship Compliance"

- EEA-Econometric Society European Meetings, Rotterdam, Netherlands 2024
- Online Political Influence and Misinformation, Stockholm School of Economics, Stockholm, Sweden 2024
- International Association for Applied Econometrics Annual Conference, Oslo, Norway 2023
- ISMS Marketing Science Conference (Special Session), Virtual 2022
- NBER Summer Institute (Political Economy), Virtual 2021
- DC IO Conference, Virtual 2021
- International Industrial Organization Conference, Virtual 2021
- TSE Digital Economics Conference, Toulouse, France 2020
- Economics of Media Workshop, Kingston, Canada (postponed*) 2020

"Asymmetric Impact of AI Matching on Influencer Marketing"

- Marketing Dynamics Conference (MDC), Santorini, Greece 2024
- 4th Invitational Pricing Symposium, London Business School, London, UK 2023
- INFORMS Annual Meeting on "Influencer Marketing," Phoenix, AZ 2023
- Kiel Institute Conference on "Artificial Intelligence and the Economy," Berlin, Germany 2023
- ISMS Marketing Science Conference, Miami, FL 2023
- EMAC Annual Conference, Odense, Denmark 2023
- POMS 33rd Annual Conference, Orlando, FL 2023
- International Industrial Organization Conference, Washington, DC 2023
- 17th Product and Service Innovation Conference, Virtual 2022
- INFORMS Annual Meeting on "Media and Social Media," Virtual 2021

"People Are More Likely to Believe and Share Fake News on Smartphones"

- Society for Consumer Psychology (SCP) Conference, San Juan, Puerto Rico 2023
- INFORMS Annual Meeting on "Misinformation and Platform Design", Indianapolis, IN 2022
- Association for Consumer Research (ACR) Conference, virtual 2022

"Less Is More: The Case of Minimalist Theory"

- Theory and Practice in Marketing (TPM) Conference, Lausanne, Switzerland 2023
- ISMS Marketing Science Conference (Special Session), Virtual 2022
- SCP Boutique Conference, Honolulu, HI 2022
- Monaco Symposium on Luxury, Monaco (canceled*) 2021
- Frank M. Bass UTD FORMS Conference, Dallas, TX 2020
- ISMS Marketing Science Conference, Philadelphia, PA 2018

"Conspicuous Consumption on the Long Tail"

- Rutgers Mentor-Mentee Symposium, Newark, NJ 2018
- Frank M. Bass UTD FORMS Conference, Dallas, TX 2017

Seminars

- Columbia University (scheduled) 2027
- The Hong Kong Polytechnic University (scheduled) 2026
- Chinese University of Hong Kong (scheduled) 2026
- University of Hong Kong (scheduled) 2026
- University of Washington (Junior Faculty Camp) 2025
- University of California San Diego, 21st Century China Center 2021
- Johns Hopkins University, Carey Business School 2019
- University of Oxford, Saïd Business School 2019
- University of Hong Kong, HKU Business School 2019
- City University of Hong Kong, College of Business 2019
- University of Western Ontario, Ivey Business School 2019
- University of Illinois at Chicago, College of Business Administration 2019
- University of Delaware, Lerner Business School 2019

Policy Panels

- Discussant at **TSE Digital Economics Conference** on "Fact-Checking and Misinformation" 2026
- Panelist at **Free Network Conference** on "Fake News and Media Literacy" 2024

GRANTS AND AWARDS

Nexus Award, Johns Hopkins University 2026
Management Science Referee Service Award 2025
ISMS Early-Career Scholars Camp Fellow 2023
General Research Support Award, Johns Hopkins University 2021, 2022, 2024
SNF Agora Faculty Grant Award, Johns Hopkins University 2022
William Polk Carey Prize for Outstanding Economics Dissertation, University of Pennsylvania 2021
President Gutmann Leadership Award 2019
AMA Doctoral Consortium Fellow 2019
Mack Institute Research Fellowship 2019
Russell Ackoff Doctoral Student Fellowship Award 2019
The SAS Dean's Travel Subvention 2019

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Reviewer Marketing Science; Management Science; Journal of Marketing Research; Journal of Marketing; International Economics Review; Journal of Economics and Management Strategy; Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization; Manufacturing and Service Operations Management; Production and Operations Management; International Journal of Research in Marketing; Hong Kong Research Grants Council

Conference Organization 2025 Workshop on Polarization in the Age of AI, Johns Hopkins University
–Carey Business School
–Krieger School of Arts and Sciences
–SNF Agora Institute
2023 INFORMS Annual Meeting
–Special Session: Influencer Marketing
2022 INFORMS Annual Meeting
–Special Session: Misinformation and Platform Design
2022 ISMS Marketing Science Conference Special Session (co-chair)
–Special Session: Politics, Ideology and Identity in Marketing
2021 INFORMS Annual Meeting
–Special Session: Media & Social Media

TEACHING

Johns Hopkins University

Instructor	BU.450.760 Customer Analytics	2022-2026
Topic:	A/B Tests, Text Mining, Matching Methods, Recommender System	
Instructor	BU.410.620 Marketing Management	2021
Topic:	Two-sided Platform, Machine Learning & AI in Marketing Research	